

STARTER

Field-by-Field Application Walkthrough

Germany - National Student Visa (Type D)

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

The National Student Visa (a national, long-stay “Type D” visa - not a Schengen visa) is applied for at the German embassy or consulate with jurisdiction over your place of residence. It's decided under the German Residence Act (Aufenthaltsgesetz), not the Schengen Visa Code. Gather the following before you begin:

- Your Zulassungsbescheid (admission letter) from a German university, or conditional admission plus enrolment in a Studienkolleg if you need a preparatory year first
- An APS certificate, if your country requires one (notably China, Vietnam, and in some cases India) - a separate academic credential verification obtained before you apply
- Valid passport
- Evidence of your German (or, for some programmes, English) language ability, per your university's requirement
- A financial mechanism meeting Germany's specific requirement - typically a Sperrkonto blocked account - see the Financial Requirements Overview (Essential tier)
- Health insurance meeting German requirements - see the Financial Requirements Overview for the GKV/private distinction

THIS VISA GETS YOU INTO GERMANY - IT ISN'T YOUR FINAL STATUS

The National Student Visa is only step one. After arriving in Germany, you register your address (Anmeldung) and then apply for a residence permit (Aufenthaltserlaubnis) at your local Ausländerbehörde, within your visa's validity window. That residence permit, not the entry visa itself, is what actually authorises you to stay for your studies - missing this follow-up step is a real, avoidable problem.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport.

2. Your university admission

- Enter your Zulassungsbescheid details exactly as issued - university, programme, and start date
- If you're admitted to a Studienkolleg first, your application reflects that preparatory path, not direct degree enrolment

3. Financial evidence

Most applicants open a Sperrkonto with an approved provider and deposit the current published annual amount, released in capped monthly instalments - see the Financial Requirements Overview for exactly how this works, and the Financial Planning Calculator (Premium tier).

4. Health insurance

You'll declare your insurance arrangement - most students under 30 at a state-recognised university use statutory public insurance (gesetzliche Krankenversicherung, GKV); others typically need private insurance. See the Financial Requirements Overview for which applies to you.

5. Background and character

Previous visas, visits, refusals, and any immigration violations - answer completely.

6. Pay the fee and attend your appointment

Pay the visa fee and attend your appointment for document submission and biometrics.

7. Submit supporting documents

Submit your Zulassungsbescheid, APS certificate if required, Sperrkonto confirmation or equivalent, and insurance evidence.